

Miners' Bats Sounding Off

After the University of Texas at El Paso's first dozen baseball games, on statistic sticks out like a sore thumb. The Miners have outscored opponents 117-38 while winning nine games.

Coach Andy Cohen's new crop of athletes have pushed some oldtimers aside in both the hitting and pitching departments but the most noticeable difference from last year's 28-24-1 team is on the mound where the UTEP hurlers are allowing 3.07 earned runs per game compared to 10.02 for opposing pitchers.

Junior college transfers Nick Fiorillo and Russell Bortell have helped make the striking difference, fanning more than one opponent per inning.

Fiorillo has struck out 21 batters in 17 innings while compiling a 3.31 era and a 2-1 record while Bortell has 20 strikeouts in 16 innings and a 1.12 era.

Jerry Walker has pitched only nine innings but has yet to allow an earned run.

Outfielder Danny Haygood found Lubbock Christian College's pitching staff to his liking, going 8-for-10 in one doubleheader to lift his batting average to .551, best among the Miner hitters.

Dan Feagler, an outfielder who plays first base when Walker is on the mound, is hitting .454 and leads UTEP with 14 runs batted in and three home runs. Rich Hildebrand, another juco transfer from Ranger, is third on the list with a .444 average followed by Bob Alsup, .395, and Art Bravo .382.

As a team, UTEP is batting a healthy .347 compared to only a .266 average the Miner hurlers are allowing opposition.

See stats in Print-Out